

TUBERCULOSIS

1. Definition of a suspect case

Cough > 15 days with or without: hemoptysis, fever, weight loss, sweating, anorexia, asthenia

2. Confirmed pulmonary tuberculosis case definition

- BK found by direct microscopy in one of three sputum donated by the patient;
- Culture on Loewenstein Jansen positive medium.

3. Screening

Perform three sputum examinations on a suspect patient; If one examination is positive, start anti-tuberculosis treatment.

If three tests negative give Amoxicillin 500 mg for two weeks. If improved stop treatment.

If no improvement, repeat three sputum examinations.

If one test positive, refer for anti-tuberculosis treatment. If three tests negative, refer for treatment.

4. Management of confirmed cases pulmonary tuberculosis

- **Directly observed treatment (DOT):** medication prescribed for the treatment of tuberculosis is taken in a single dose, preferably in the morning on an empty stomach, under the direct supervision of a member of the nursing staff.

- **Defining positive therapeutic cases of pulmonary tuberculosis:**

New case: patient who has never received anti-tuberculosis treatment or who has taken anti-tuberculosis drugs for less than four weeks.

Failure: patient continues to give positive smears at 5th month of treatment, retreatment schedule (8 months)

Relapse: a patient with a positive sputum examination after having been declared "cured" or "treatment completed" at the end of a full course of treatment.

Return after discontinuation: patient who has discontinued treatment for more than 2 consecutive months and returns to CDS. Sputum tests must be repeated, and if positive, the retreatment schedule (8 months) is applied.

Treatment regimens :

Treatment categories	TB patient classification	Treatment regimens		Total treatment time (in months)
		Initial phase	Continuation phase	
I.	New TPM+ case	2 RHZE	4 RH	6
II.	Retreatment (relapse, failure, resumption of treatment after discontinuation)	2 RHZES 1 RHZE	5 HRE	8

[R: rifampicin, H: isoniazid, Z: pyrazinamide, E: ethambutol, S: streptomycin; the number before the letters indicates the number of months.

Cured: patient who has received full treatment and has negative bacteriological tests at 5th and/or 6th months.

Treatment completed: patient who has received a full course of treatment but has not undergone bacteriological checks at the end of the course.

- **Sputum control tests:** at 2nd, 5th, 6th months and 8th months in the event of retreatment. If this is not possible, send the sputum sample to the nearest CDT. **If C 2 is positive**, the initial phase should be extended by 1 month of treatment; do C3 and, whatever the result, start the 2nd phase.